
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Moving house



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Georgie

Hello and welcome to Real Easy English. We're back with another conversation in easy English to help you learn. I'm Georgie.

Neil

And I'm Neil. Don't forget that there's a video version of this podcast on our website, bbclearningenglish.com. You can read along with the subtitles and download a free worksheet.

Georgie

Hello Neil. How are you doing?

Neil

Hi Georgie. Yeah, I'm fine. How are you?

Georgie

Yes, I'm very well too, thank you. Today, Neil, in this conversation, we're talking about moving house. So, when was the last time you moved house?

Neil

Oh, I moved house probably 12 years ago.

Georgie

Oh wow! And why did you move to where you live now?

Neil

Because my family was getting bigger. More children need more space, so we moved to somewhere bigger and further out of London. How about you?

Georgie

I rent my flat. And the place I was living before – the owners of the place wanted to sell the house, so I needed to move because I couldn't live there anymore. And also, my friend had this flat and he was offering me very cheap rent, so that's why I live

there. But I'm very happy there because it's between two really nice parks. It has good transport links and, yeah, it was a good decision.

Neil

And how was the move itself?

Georgie

The move was actually very easy because I don't have many **possessions**. I'm a bit of a minimalist. The reason is because I moved country, so I just didn't really have many things to bring back to the UK, so I didn't need a big van or anything. I just ordered a taxi and put all of my bags in the taxi and it was very easy. And what about you?

Neil

It was the opposite of that.

Georgie

Oh no!

Neil

We had a **removal van** and some **removal men**, who came and **packed** everything up in boxes to make sure that things were easy to carry into the van, and also that they didn't get damaged. And then they drove all of our stuff to my new house.

Georgie

Yeah. Did you have... did you have any **fragile** bits? So, **fragile** means that it's easy to break, not very strong. Plates and things – did you have...?

Neil

Yes. Those things had to be wrapped and protected, otherwise they would break.

Georgie

Yes. And did you have to move furniture as well?

Neil

Yeah, we had to move sofas and cupboards and wardrobes and heavy things like that, yeah.

Georgie

It does sound different to my experience, doesn't it? I didn't have any furniture to take. Do you find moving house exciting? Scary? How do you feel about moving house?

Neil

I think it's both. It's exciting and scary. It's exciting because this is going to be your new life, or where your new life will happen. But it's also scary because you don't know what that's going to be like. You don't know what your neighbours are going to be like.

Georgie

That's very true.

Neil

You don't know what your new friends are going to be like.

Georgie

Yes.

Neil

So, there's lots of things that you don't know. And that's scary, but also exciting.

Georgie

Yeah, a lot of uncertainty for sure. Yeah, I think it can depend. It depends if you're moving somewhere better or worse. But yeah, I was quite excited when I moved because I knew that my new flat had a nice outdoor terrace. As I said, we were close to parks and stuff, so I was excited.

Neil

So, Georgie, if you are planning a move, what do you need to do to prepare?

Georgie

Well, you need to do things like setting up WiFi in the new house. Other bills, like electricity and heating, gas – you need to put your name on the accounts. You need to plan what you're going to take. So, when you move, it's a really good time to look at all of your **possessions** and think, what do I need? Maybe I can get rid of stuff, so throw stuff away. Have you got any other ideas? What else can you do to prepare for a move?

Neil

You can hire a **removal company** or **van** if you're doing it yourself, if you're... if you need to transport your stuff to your new house and you can't just use a taxi. Yeah.

Georgie

Sounds like a lot of work. I don't want to move anytime soon.

Neil

No.

Georgie

You?

Neil

Me neither. No.

Georgie

OK. Let's recap the language we heard during the conversation. We heard **possessions**, which are the things that you own or have. For example, my phone and my clothes are my **possessions**.

Neil

We talked about **removal vans**. A **removal van** is a large vehicle that people put your **possessions** into to go from one home to another, and the company is called a **removals company** or **removals firm**.

Georgie

We heard **packing**, and **packing** is where you put your own things into boxes, so that a removal firm can take them to your new home.

Neil

And we heard **fragile**. **Fragile** is an adjective which describes something that can break easily. For example, glass – glass is **fragile**.

Georgie

That's it for this episode of Real Easy English. Don't forget to test what you've learned using the free worksheet on our website. Go to bbclearningenglish.com.

Neil

We'll be back next week with another conversation in easy English. Bye for now.

Georgie
Goodbye.